

Slide 1: Introduction to WikiLeaks

WikiLeaks: A Global Platform for Whistleblowing

WikiLeaks is a non-profit media organization founded by Julian Assange in 2006, dedicated to publishing classified and sensitive documents from anonymous sources^[1] ^[2]. Created as a secure platform for whistleblowers, the organization aims to bring important and often hidden information to public attention^[3].

Key Founding Details

- Founded by Julian Assange, an Australian computer programmer and activist
- Registered domain in 1999, but actively launched in 2006
- Designed as an "uncensorable system for untraceable mass document leaking" ^[3:1]

Initial Characteristics

- Initially used a wiki model allowing site editing (which was later changed)
- First publication in December 2006 was an unverified document from a Somali rebel leader
- Rapidly grew to over 1.2 million documents in its first year^[2:1]

Organizational Philosophy

Assange envisioned WikiLeaks as a platform practicing "scientific journalism" - providing primary source materials with minimal editorial commentary^[4]. The organization seeks to expose governmental, corporate, and institutional secrets while protecting the identities of its sources^[2:2].

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1. <https://www.britannica.com/topic/WikiLeaks>
2. <https://simple.wikipedia.org/wiki/WikiLeaks>
3. https://ccnmtl.columbia.edu/projects/caseconsortium/casestudies/70/casestudy/www/layout/case_id_70_id_627.html
4. <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Julian-Assange>